

McKinsey to donate open source tool Kedro to Linux Foundation



McKinsey and Company has announced that it will donate open source tool Kedro to the Linux Foundation. Kedro is expected to be hosted by LF AI & Data, a specialist Linux Foundation umbrella organisation founded in 2018 to accelerate development and innovation in AI and data by supporting and connecting technical open source projects, developer communities, and some 1000 companies.

Kedro, the first open source software tool for data scientists and data engineers launched in 2019, is a library of code that can be used to create data and machine learning pipelines, the building blocks of any analytics project.

Available on the open source platform GitHub, the Kedro community and user base has now grown with more than 200,000 monthly downloads and over 100 contributors.

“It addresses the many challenges that exist in creating machine learning products today, and it is a fantastic complement to our portfolio of hosted technical projects. We look forward to working with the community to grow the project’s footprint and to create new collaboration opportunities with our members, hosted projects, and the larger open source community,” said Dr Ibrahim Haddad, executive director of LF AI & Data.

Kedro is now in the hands of the data science ecosystem. “This is the only way it can grow at this point; if it is improved by people around the world,” explained Yetunde Dada, the Kedro product lead. “Our cross-disciplinary team gets to see the increased development and validation of Kedro with this milestone. It establishes Kedro as a *de facto* industry tool, joining a collection of other cutting-edge open source projects such as Kubernetes donated by Google, GraphQL by Facebook, and MLFlow and Delta Lake by Databricks.”

Kubernetes adoption continues to grow: CNCF survey

The Cloud Native Survey 2021 by the Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF) has found that the usage of Kubernetes is continuing to grow and has reached its highest level ever, with 96 per cent of organisations using or evaluating the technology.

“Kubernetes has been fully embraced by large enterprises and is even growing in emerging technology hubs, like Africa, where 73 per cent of respondents use Kubernetes in production,” reads an official release from CNCF.

Airbyte continues to grow as open source data integration platform

Airbyte, the open source data integration platform, grew deployments per month by 6x, doubled GitHub stars, and raised more than US\$ 181 million in funding in 2021. The company has also announced an integration with Dagster, the data orchestration platform, as Airbyte’s technology becomes the industry standard for data integration.

“The total funding in 2021 will allow us to reach our 2022 goals much quicker: expanding our team from 30 people today to over 200 members; growing from 16,000 deployments today to 100,000; and increasing from 150 connectors currently to 500 by the end of the year,” said Michel Tricot, co-founder and CEO, Airbyte. “The integration with Dagster brings additional productivity to users, especially in scaling their data pipelines.”

Dagster is an orchestration platform for the development, production, and observation of data assets. It enables practitioners to define jobs in terms of the data flow, and with a fast develop and test workflow. Dagster unifies disparate data tools into a cohesive data platform, making practitioners dramatically more productive, scaling from ‘single-player-mode’ to large organisations, and providing context for all stakeholders.

Airbyte’s open source data integration solves two problems. First, companies always have to build and maintain data connectors on their own because most not-so-popular ‘long tail’ data connectors are not supported by closed-source ELT technologies. Second, data teams often have to do custom work around pre-built connectors to make them work within their unique data infrastructure.